

The 9/11 Dossier

A deep-research case seed for Aletheia — contested claims of September 11, decomposed into atomic claims, mapped evidence, and the experiments that would settle them

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Executive summary

The September 11, 2001 attacks killed **2,977 victims** — 2,753 at the World Trade Center, 184 at the Pentagon, and 40 in Pennsylvania — and have since killed thousands more through exposure-related illness: the CDC's World Trade Center Health Program counted **132,530 enrolled responders and survivors and 6,897 deceased members (all causes) as of March 2024**. ([Britannica](#)) The official account — nineteen al-Qaeda hijackers, four commandeered airliners, impact-plus-fire collapses in New York — rests on an enormous, convergent record: flight data recorders, DNA identification of victims including the hijackers' remains by elimination, seismic and video timing, thousands of interviews, and the largest building-failure investigation ever conducted, NIST's 47-report, ~11,000-page WTC study. ([wikipedia.org](#)) Osama bin Laden publicly claimed responsibility in a 2004 video, and Khalid Sheikh Mohammed told a Guantánamo tribunal in 2007: "I was responsible for the 9/11 operation, from A to Z." ([wikipedia.org](#))

And yet the case is not closed in the way most people assume — not because the demolition theories are right, but because specific, checkable fractures remain in the official record, and some of them are load-bearing for public trust. The honest state of play, decomposed:

- **Established without serious dispute:** the four flights, their hijackers, the timeline, al-Qaeda's operational responsibility, the impact-plus-fire initiation of the Twin Towers' collapses, the presence of anomalous pre-attack option trading, and the fact that U.S. agencies held fragmented pre-attack warnings — "the system was blinking red." ([Human Factors 101](#))
- **Documented official misconduct:** the EPA's "air is safe" statements were shaped by White House edits and made without sufficient data (EPA Inspector General, 2003); FAA and NORAD gave the 9/11 Commission inaccurate testimony about the air-defense response; the CIA withheld and destroyed interrogation videotapes the Commission had sought. ([wikipedia.org](#))
- **Genuinely contested in the technical literature:** the cause of WTC 7's collapse, where NIST's "fire-induced progressive collapse" model (2008) faces the University of Alaska Fairbanks' four-year reevaluation (2020) concluding "**fire did not cause the collapse of WTC 7**" — while NIST has withheld 68,500 of ~91,114 modeling data files under a "might jeopardize public safety" finding upheld in court. ([NIST](#))
- **Unresolved and active in court:** the extent of Saudi state-linked support for the hijackers. The "28 pages" were declassified in 2016; FBI documents released under Executive Order 14040 (2021) identified Omar al-Bayoumi as an agent of Saudi intelligence; on **August 28, 2025, U.S. District Judge George B. Daniels denied Saudi Arabia's motion to dismiss and ordered the families' case to trial**. ([wikipedia.org](#))
- **Contradicted by the best available evidence:** controlled demolition of the Twin Towers, nanothermite as the red/gray chips' identity (the strongest counter-analysis finds epoxy paint), no-

plane-at-the-Pentagon theories, and the claim that insiders had *specific* advance knowledge of the plot. (NIST)

This report is engineered as a **seed for an Aletheia case**. Every section maps onto Aletheia records: atomic claims with IDs (NYC-C001...), evidence records with direction and strength, a source ledger with honest verification labels, research opportunities that name the experiments which would settle each crux, and a drop-in `content/cases/september-11-attacks/` folder conforming to the Zod schema in `src/domain/schema.ts`. Nothing here is fabricated; every source in the ledger is a real document, and its verification status is labeled exactly as Aletheia's content policy requires.

1. How to read this dossier

Aletheia's method is to decompose a controversial hypothesis into **atomic claims**, grade each on two axes — **credibility** (is the local claim true?) and **diagnosticity** (how much does it favor one hypothesis over its rivals?) — map evidence records for and against with explicit direction, and keep *what the source says* strictly separate from *what we infer from it*. This dossier follows that discipline throughout. Where the two sides of a dispute agree on a fact (the 2.25 seconds of free fall; the 4,744 UAL puts), the fact is marked **established**, and the contest is relocated to the interpretation, which is where it actually lives. This single move dissolves roughly half of the popular 9/11 debate, which mostly argues about observations both parties already accept.

The dossier also adopts Aletheia's **argument ladder**: *observation* claims (what was measured) sit at the bottom, *mechanism* claims (how it physically worked) in the middle, *attribution* claims (who is responsible) at the top. The pattern in the 9/11 record is striking and is the spine of this report: the observations are largely settled and often genuinely anomalous; the mechanisms are contested in a few specific places; and the attributions — “inside job,” “controlled demolition,” “foreknowledge” — are the least supported rung, surviving mainly on the (real) documented instances of official deception elsewhere in the record. Readers should also note what this report deliberately does **not** do: it does not adjudicate motives, and it treats the victims' families — who drove the creation of the 9/11 Commission, the declassification of the 28 pages, the EPA reckoning, and the Saudi litigation — as the central stakeholders of every unresolved question, not as props for either side.

The argument ladder: the 9/11 case decomposed into Aletheia's three rungs

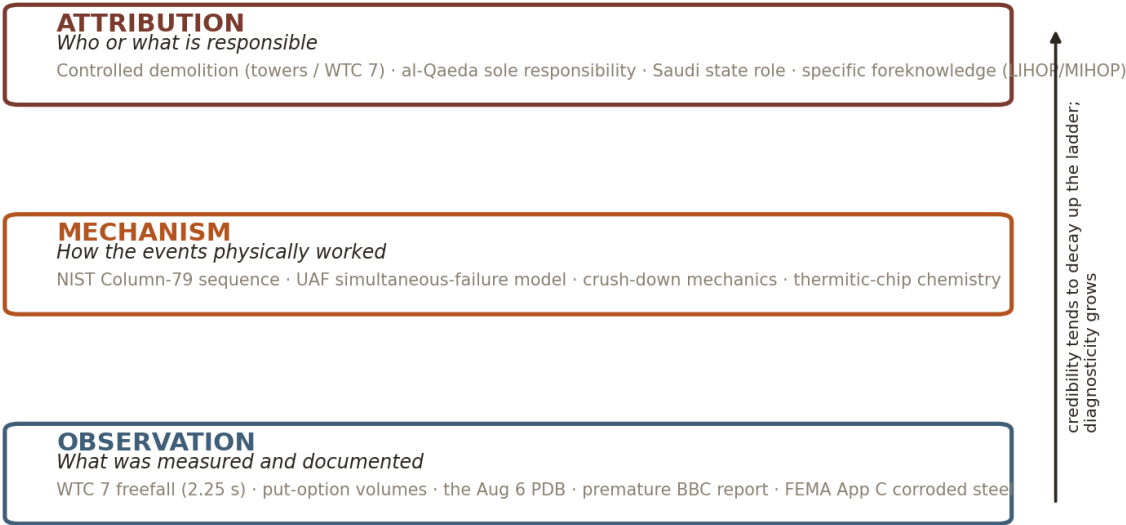


Figure 1: The argument ladder

2. The verified skeleton: what happened, and the toll

2.1 The timeline both sides must accept

Before any contested claim can be evaluated, the uncontested chronological skeleton must be fixed, because several popular claims die on contact with it. The timing below comes from NIST’s video analysis (impact and collapse times calibrated to broadcast time stamps), the NTSB’s flight path study for American 77, and Columbia’s Lamont-Doherty seismographs, which independently fixed the tower impacts at 8:46:26 and 9:02:54 within seconds of NIST’s 8:46:30 and 9:02:59. (Human Factors 101) American Airlines Flight 11 struck the North Tower at **8:46:30 a.m.**; United 175 struck the South Tower at **9:02:59**; American 77 hit the Pentagon at **9:37:45** at roughly 460 knots; the South Tower collapsed at **9:58:59** — 56 minutes after impact; United 93 crashed near Shanksville, Pennsylvania at **10:03:11**; the North Tower collapsed at **10:28:22** — 102 minutes after impact; and WTC 7, never struck by an aircraft, collapsed at **5:20:52 p.m.** after burning for almost seven hours. (Human Factors 101)

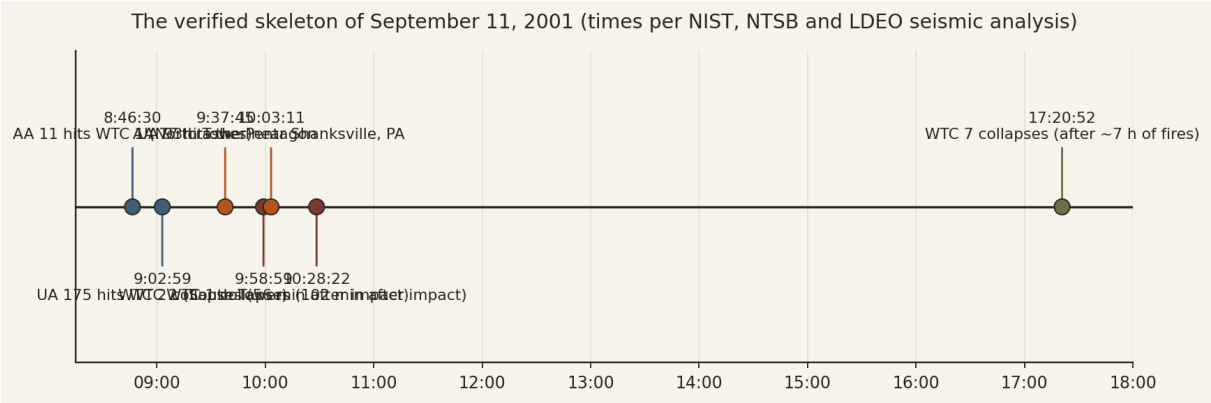


Figure 2: Verified timeline of September 11, 2001

The skeleton matters analytically in both directions. Against the demolition reading: the towers visibly initiated at the impact-and-fire floors, after intervals (56 and 102 minutes) that tracked each aircraft’s damage geometry rather than any detonation schedule, and the Lamont-Doherty seismic record contains the collapse signals beginning roughly ten seconds *after* each collapse initiation — with **no pre-collapse spike** of the kind charges would produce. (NIST) Against complacent readings of the official account: the same skeleton shows that the air-defense system failed completely within the window — the Commission documented that NORAD and FAA testimony claiming timely tracking of United 93 was wrong by its own tapes — and that WTC 7’s fall, hours after the last impact and after FDNY had withdrawn, is a genuinely separate structural event requiring separate explanation. (wikipedia.org)

2.2 The toll, immediate and deferred

The immediate count is precise and brutal: **2,977 victims** excluding the 19 hijackers — 2,753 at the World Trade Center (including **343 FDNY firefighters**, 71 law-enforcement officers, and 8 private EMTs), 184 at the Pentagon (125 in the building, 59 aboard Flight 77), and 40 aboard Flight 93; citizens of at least 102 countries died. (wikipedia.org) NIST’s own tower accounting — 2,735 deaths in the towers including those aboard the two aircraft — gives the finer breakdown: everyone above the 91st floor of WTC 1 died; in WTC 2, the 18-minute gap between impacts allowed most below-impact occupants to escape, and roughly 40% of occupants had already left before the second strike. (NIST)

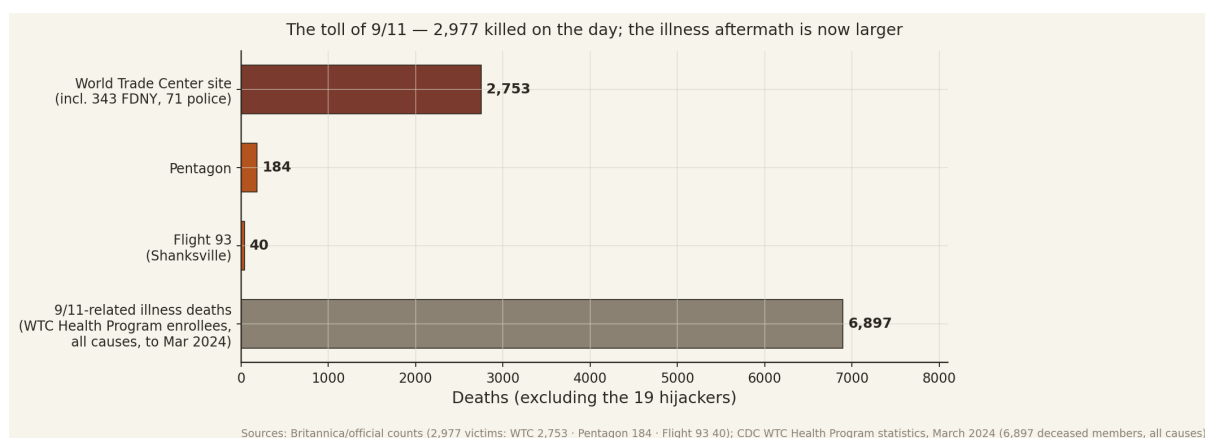


Figure 3: The toll of 9/11

The deferred toll is the part that changes the case’s moral weight a quarter-century on. The collapse aerosolized an unprecedented mixture — pulverized concrete, gypsum, glass fibers, asbestos at 0.8–3.0% of mass in early bulk samples, lead at 101–625 µg/g, PAHs, dioxins — characterized in the peer-reviewed literature within weeks. (nih.gov) The World Trade Center Health Program created by the **Zadroga Act (2011)** has grown every quarter since: **132,530 members** as of March 2024, of whom **6,897 have died** (all causes), with nearly 50,000 certified 9/11-related cancers reported by advocates tracking the program in 2025; the September 11th Victim Compensation Fund had made over 69,000 determinations totaling **\$16.16 billion** by September 2025. (CDC) More people enrolled in the health program have now died than were killed on the day — a fact that belongs in any honest framing of what “the events of 9/11” still are. (wikipedia.org)

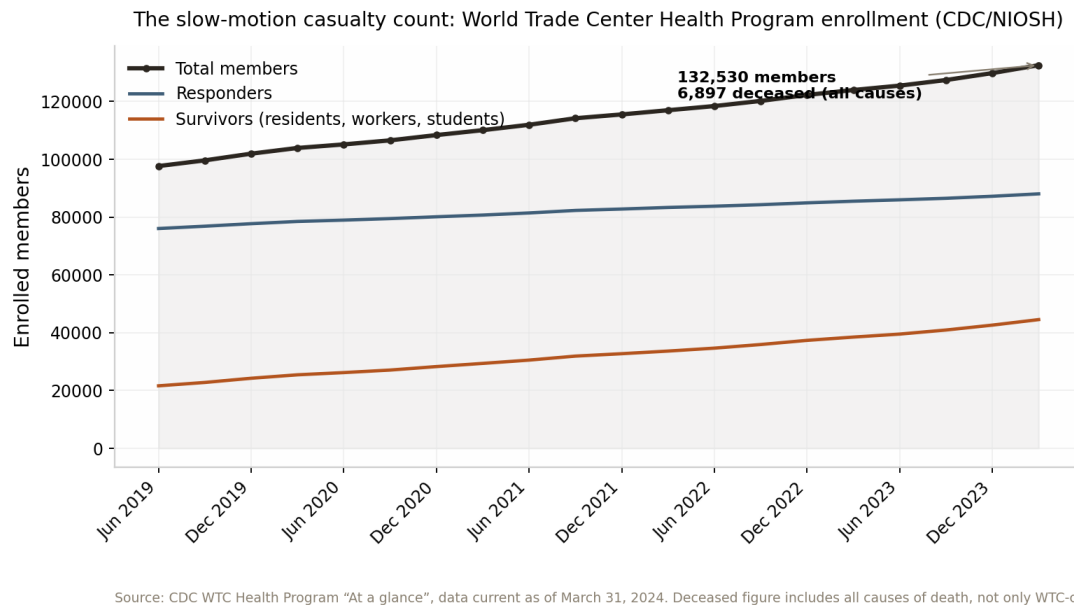


Figure 4: WTC Health Program enrollment

3. The official investigations — and their own documented limits

3.1 The investigative architecture

Four federal or professional efforts anchor the conventional record. The **Joint Inquiry** of the House and Senate intelligence committees (final report December 2002, public July 2003) mapped the intelligence failures and concluded that while significant al-Qaeda threat reporting existed, “none of it identified the time, place, and specific nature of the attacks.” ([Levin Center for Legislative Oversight and Democracy](#)) The **9/11 Commission** (report July 22, 2004) produced the canonical narrative and 41 recommendations, while itself documenting the insider-trading trace-outs and the watchlisting failures. ([History](#)) On the engineering side, **FEMA’s Building Performance Study** (FEMA 403, May 2002) was the preliminary federal look, superseded by the **NIST investigation** mandated by the National Construction Safety Team Act: the towers’ final report (NCSTAR 1, October 2005, with 42 companion volumes) and the WTC 7 report (NCSTAR 1A, November 2008). ([wtc7.net](#)) The **ASCE Pentagon Building Performance Report** (January 2003) covered Arlington. ([ASCE](#))

NIST’s effort was historically large: roughly 200 technical experts, ~7,000 video segments, ~7,000 photographs, interviews with over 1,000 people, metallurgical and mechanical analysis of **236 recovered steel pieces**, and end-to-end simulations that took about two months per tower and eight months for WTC 7 on then-current hardware. ([U.S. Department of Commerce](#)) Its conclusions — impact damage plus dislodged fireproofing plus multi-floor fires for the towers; thermal expansion, girder walk-off, and Column 79 buckling for WTC 7 — are treated claim-by-claim below. The investigation also produced **30 recommendations** for the towers and 13 for WTC 7, and NIST credits them with more than 40 changes to building and fire codes — an important datum in itself, because it shows the official investigation found the *existing* built environment genuinely vulnerable to what happened, which cuts against any claim that the collapses required exotic causes to be worth learning from. ([U.S. Department of Commerce](#))

3.2 The Commission's self-documented weaknesses

Any dossier that treats the 9/11 Commission Report as scripture fails Aletheia's provenance standard, because the Commission's own principals documented its defects. Co-chairs **Thomas Kean and Lee Hamilton** titled their 2006 memoir *Without Precedent* and concluded the panel was "**set up to fail**": created late, given \$3 million initially against its needs, opposed by the White House for over a year, and — in Hamilton's words — deceived by key agencies including NORAD and the FAA. ([wikipedia.org](#)) The Commission was forced to use subpoenas to obtain FAA and NORAD material; staff director John Farmer said he was "shocked at how different the truth was from the way it was described," after tapes showed NORAD had never had any hijacked airliner in its sights and at one point chased the long-crashed American 11 as a phantom. ([wikipedia.org](#))

Two further provenance caveats attach to the report's central chapters. First, NBC News's 2008 analysis found that **more than a quarter of the report's footnotes** trace to CIA interrogations of detainees subjected to "enhanced interrogation techniques" — later determined to be torture — and executive director Philip Zelikow conceded that "quite a bit, if not most" of the plot narrative came from interrogations; at least four cited detainees said they told interrogators what would stop the torture. ([wikipedia.org](#)) Second, the CIA in November 2005 **destroyed videotapes of those interrogations** despite the Commission's 2003–04 requests for interrogation material, prompting Kean and Hamilton to accuse the agency of consciously impeding the inquiry; the CIA countered that staff never specifically asked for videos. ([wikipedia.org](#)) Philip Shenon's *The Commission* (2008) separately documented Zelikow's undisclosed White House contacts during the inquiry. ([wikipedia.org](#)) None of this falsifies the report's core findings — but it establishes, in Aletheia terms, that the canonical narrative's sourcing is weaker at exactly the nodes (plot origin, detainee testimony, air-defense timeline) where independent corroboration is thinnest, and it is legitimate to grade those nodes accordingly.

3.3 NIST's self-imposed limits

NIST's engineering reports carry their own documented scope limits, which both sides routinely over-read in opposite directions. The towers' investigation explicitly covered events **from aircraft impact to collapse initiation**; NIST's own FAQ states that once collapse began, "the propagation of the collapse was readily explained without the same complexity of modeling," and its report's footnote concedes the "probable collapse sequence" contains "little analysis of the structural behavior of the tower after the conditions for collapse initiation were reached." ([NIST](#)) NIST did **not** test recovered steel for explosive or thermite residues, judging the fire/impact evidence conclusive and residue analysis non-diagnostic (sulfur being ubiquitous in gypsum wallboard). ([NIST](#)) For WTC 7, **no identified steel was recovered** — unmarked pieces had been recycled before they could be catalogued, unlike the color-coded tower steel — a fact NIST states openly and which remains the single largest physical-evidence gap in the whole case. ([NIST](#))

The sharpest transparency limit is legal, not technical. Under §7(d) of the NCST Act, the NIST Director found in July 2009 that releasing parts of the WTC 7 modeling data "might jeopardize public safety," and NIST ultimately **withheld 68,500 of 91,114 responsive data files** while releasing 25,644; the U.S. District Court for D.C. upheld the withholding in *Quick v. NIST* (April 7, 2011), on the ground that detailed connection models validated against a real collapse could instruct someone how to destroy similar buildings. ([GovInfo](#)) Whatever its legal soundness, the practical consequence stands: the initiating mechanism of the most contested building collapse in history cannot be fully reproduced by independent engineers from NIST's own published materials, thirteen years after the report — and the University of Alaska study discussed in §5 exists precisely in that vacuum. ([Architects & Engineers for 9/11 Truth](#))

4. The case, decomposed

The full decomposition lives in the companion seed files (`claims.yaml`, `evidence.yaml`, `sources.yaml`). The map below shows the landscape at a glance: **26 featured claims** plotted on Aletheia’s two axes. The visual pattern is the argument: a solid left flank of established observations (freefall, put volumes, the PDB, the early BBC report, corroded steel), a contested middle where the WTC 7 mechanism claims and the trading/foreknowledge interpretations sit, and a right flank where the strong attribution claims — demolition of the towers, specific foreknowledge — land in the “against” family on current evidence.

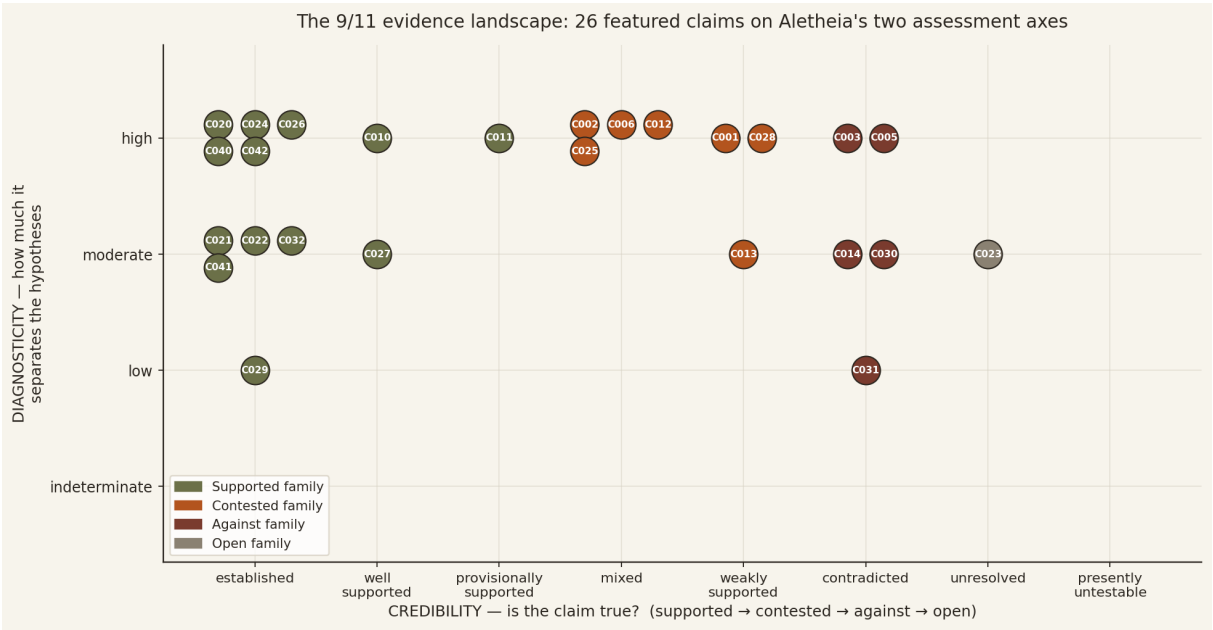


Figure 5: The 9/11 evidence landscape

ID	Claim (abbreviated)	Rung	Credibility	Diagnosticity	Theme
NYC-C001	1 WTC building was demolished with pre-planted devices	Attribution	weakly_supported	high	collapses
NYC-C002	WTC 7 specifically was demolished	Attribution	mixed	high	wtc7
NYC-C003	The Twin Towers were demolished	Attribution	contradicted	high	collapses
NYC-C005	US officials had specific foreknowledge of the plot	Attribution	contradicted	high	foreknowledge

Table 1 – continued

ID	Claim (abbreviated)	Rung	Credibility	Diagnosticity	Theme
NYC-C006	Saudi-government-connected individuals supported hijackers; extent of state role unresolved	Attribution	mixed	high	saudi
NYC-C010	Impact + dislodged fireproofing + fires initiated tower collapses (NIST)	Mechanism	well_supported	high	collapses
NYC-C011	Once initiated, total progressive collapse of the towers was inevitable	Mechanism	provisionally_supported	high	collapses
NYC-C012	Fire alone caused WTC 7 via Column 79 sequence (NIST)	Mechanism	mixed	high	wtc7
NYC-C013	Only near-simultaneous failure of every column explains WTC 7 (UAF)	Mechanism	weakly_supported	moderate	wtc7
NYC-C014	Red/gray chips in WTC dust are unreacted nanothermite	Mechanism	contradicted	moderate	dust
NYC-C020	WTC 7' s north face free-fell ~2.25 s over ~32 m	Observation	established	high	wtc7
NYC-C021	Glowing molten metal poured from WTC 2 before collapse	Observation	established	moderate	dust

Table 1 – continued

ID	Claim (abbreviated)	Rung	Credibility	Diagnosticity	Theme
NYC-C022	FEMA App. C steel shows sulfidation/ eutectic erosion	Observation	established	moderate	dust
NYC-C023	Molten steel persisted for weeks in the rubble	Observation	unresolved	moderate	dust
NYC-C024	UAL/AMR put volumes were anomalously high pre-9/11	Observation	established	high	trading
NYC-C025	The trading pattern reflects advance knowledge	Attribution	mixed	high	trading
NYC-C026	Agencies held fragmented pre-attack warnings ("blinking red")	Historical	established	high	foreknowledge
NYC-C027	FAA/NORAD gave inaccurate air-defense testimony	Historical	well_supported	moderate	foreknowledge
NYC-C028	Able Danger identified Atta pre-9/11	Historical	weakly_supported	high	foreknowledge
NYC-C029	BBC reported WTC 7' s collapse ~26 min early	Observation	established	low	media
NYC-C030	Premature reports demonstrate foreknowledge of WTC 7' s fall	Interpretive	contradicted	moderate	media
NYC-C031	Silverstein' s "pull it" was a demolition admission	Interpretive	contradicted	low	media

Table 1 – continued

ID	Claim (abbreviated)	Rung	Credibility	Diagnosticity	Theme
NYC-C032	EPA’ s “safe air” statements lacked data; White House edited them	Historical	established	moderate	health
NYC-C040	Flight 77 struck the Pentagon at 9:37:45 (anchor claim)	Observation	established	high	pentagon
NYC-C041	Flight 93 crashed near Shanksville after a passenger revolt; no intercept	Observation	established	moderate	flight93
NYC-C042	Al-Qaeda carried out the attacks under KSM’ s planning (anchor claim)	Attribution	established	high	authorship

Plus three tombstones (rejected claims kept with their rejection reasons): NYC-C900 (no plane at the Pentagon), NYC-C901 (directed-energy/nuclear devices), NYC-C902 (the “4,000 stayed home” fabrication).

The remainder of the report walks the contested and load-bearing clusters in detail, in the order of their diagnostic weight: WTC 7 first (the case’s true crux), then the tower mechanics, the dust forensics, the two other crash sites, the trading anomaly, the foreknowledge record, the Saudi question, and the two “calibration” episodes — EPA and the media anomalies — that teach how to weigh institutional credibility without either naïveté or paranoia.

5. WTC 7 — the case’s true crux

5.1 Why a 47-story building nobody was killed in carries the case

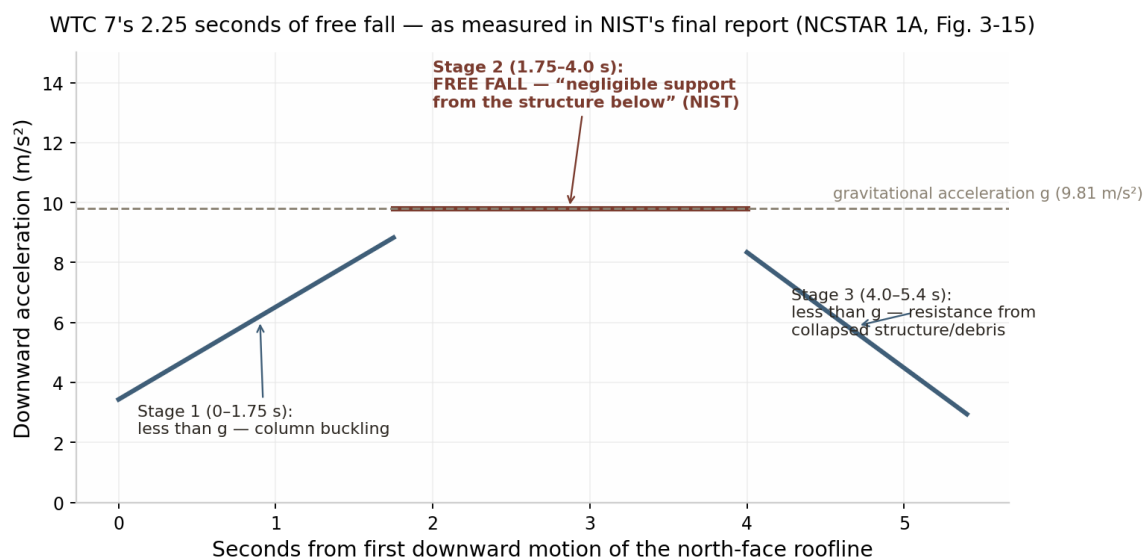
WTC 7 killed no one — FDNY abandoned firefighting roughly three hours before the collapse, and the ~4,000 occupants evacuated — yet it is the load-bearing node of the entire 9/11 controversy, for a structural reason: **it removes the two confounders that explain the towers.** No aircraft hit it, and no jet fuel soaked it. If office fires alone, ignited by debris, brought down a modern 47-story steel-frame building in a few hours, that is (a) the first such event in recorded engineering history — NIST itself called it “**the first known instance of fire causing the total collapse of a tall building**” — and (b) an event whose mechanics must be airtight, because the whole demolition reading of 9/11 stands or falls here. (NIST) Debris from WTC 1, 370 feet away, ignited fires on at least ten floors; only the fires on

floors **7–9 and 11–13** burned out of control, fed by ordinary office contents, after the towers' collapse cut the city water main feeding the lower-floor sprinklers. (NIST)

NIST's probable collapse sequence, finalized in NCSTAR 1A (November 2008), runs: thermal expansion of long-span floor beams on the east side → the Floor-13 girder between Columns 79 and 44 (A2001) pushed off its seat → Floor 13 collapses → cascading floor failures leave **Column 79** unsupported over nine stories → Column 79 buckles (the initiation event, visible as the east penthouse sinking) → failure progresses upward and then east-to-west through the core (columns 58–78) → the façade buckles between floors 7 and 17 and the building falls as a unit. (NIST) Critically, NIST's own thermal analysis found **column temperatures stayed below ~300 °C** and only east-side floor beams exceeded 600 °C — the mechanism runs on **thermal expansion**, not steel “melting,” at temperatures hundreds of degrees below conventional fire-resistance assumptions. (NIST) This is a scientifically respectable, internally consistent account. It is also, uniquely among the day's events, an account for which **no identified physical steel from the building survives in evidence.** (NIST)

5.2 The free fall: the fact, and the fight over what it means

The case's most famous number is now agreed by everyone. In the August 2008 draft report, NIST stated the north face descended 18 stories in 5.4 seconds — 40% longer than free fall — and lead investigator Shyam Sunder, challenged by physics teacher **David Chandler** at the public briefing, answered: “A free-fall time would be an object that has no structural components below it.” (International Fire & Safety Journal) After the comment period, the final report re-analyzed the roofline motion and concluded the descent had three stages: **Stage 1** (0–1.75 s) slower than gravity as exterior columns buckled; **Stage 2** (1.75–4.0 s) at **gravitational acceleration — free fall — for approximately 2.25 seconds over ~32 m (105 ft, ~8 stories)**, during which “the buckled columns provided negligible support to the upper portion”; **Stage 3** (4.0–5.4 s) decelerating as the falling face met debris resistance. (NIST)



Acceleration curve drawn to NIST's three-stage description; Stage 2 $\approx$ 32 m (105 ft, ~8 stories) at g . Stage 1/3 profiles schematic within NIST's stated bounds.

Figure 6: WTC 7 descent analysis

Both readings of this fact are internally coherent, and the dossier keeps them separate. **NIST's:** once the interior had progressively collapsed (the east penthouse fell ~4 seconds before the exterior moved), the shell had essentially nothing inside it for those eight stories; free fall of the hollowed façade is the *expected*

signature of the fire-progressive sequence, not a refutation of it — and NIST’s structural model showed buckled columns losing load capacity at exactly that interval. (NIST) **The challengers’**: 2.25 seconds of *symmetric, building-wide* free fall requires every one of the ~81 columns across eight stories to lose nearly all resistance simultaneously, an event fire — a spatially and temporally diffuse process — does not obviously produce; Chandler’s independent tracking showed all visible roofline points transitioning to free fall together. (International Fire & Safety Journal) The observation is **established**; its diagnosticity is real but bounded — free fall is a *necessary* feature of any plausible account, NIST’s included, so it discriminates less than either side advertises. What genuinely discriminates is the *initiation* — which is where the UAF study aimed.

5.3 The UAF reevaluation (2020): the strongest challenge on the record

Between 2015 and 2019, a University of Alaska Fairbanks team led by forensic structural engineer **J. Leroy Hulsey** — funded with **\$316,153 from Architects & Engineers for 9/11 Truth** — rebuilt WTC 7 in SAP2000 and ABAQUS from the structural drawings and re-ran the fire response. Its March 25, 2020 final report, *A Structural Reevaluation of the Collapse of World Trade Center 7*, concluded: **“fire did not cause the collapse of WTC 7”** — fires could not have produced the member displacements NIST’s initiation requires (the girder could not walk off past Column 79’s side plate; the east-side framing was stiffer than modeled) — and, secondarily, that the observed behavior is matched only by **near-simultaneous failure of every column in the building** (core columns over eight stories, then exterior columns 1.3 s later). (INE University of Alaska Fairbanks) The team released its **entire dataset — 256 GB compressed** — for public replication, a transparency standard NIST has not met. (INE University of Alaska Fairbanks)

The counter-case is equally specific. NIST, denying AE911Truth’s 2020 **Request for Correction**, answered the girder objection directly: the 16-story ANSYS model’s connection detail *is* consistent with the fabrication shop drawings, with the A2001 bolts on a seated connection attached to the exterior edges of Column 79’s side plates — i.e., NIST claims the side plate was modeled, and the request was denied on that basis. (metabunk.org) Independent engineering critics (the Metabunk analysis community being the most thorough public record) found category-level flaws in the UAF work: it modeled a **single static temperature distribution** rather than migrating fires; it focused on one connection when NIST’s initiation involved several; its displacement comparisons mixed global and local frames; and its Section 4.6 “best fit” simulation reproduces only the trivial feature — free fall, which any column-removal scenario yields by construction — while failing the observed **kink in the roofline, the east-penthouse sequence timing, and the rotational deformation** seen in video. (metabunk.org) Two reviews were solicited from academics sympathetic to the sponsor (e.g., McMaster emeritus Robert Korol), not from the fire-engineering mainstream; the paper has not passed independent journal peer review. (Construct-Connect)

The dossier’s honest grade: **NYC-C012 (NIST’s fire mechanism)** is “mixed” — internally consistent, produced by the best-resourced investigation, but never independently reproduced and resting on withheld model files; **NYC-C013 (UAF’s simultaneous-failure requirement)** is **“weakly_supported”** — a serious modeling effort with disclosed data, but sponsor-funded, not peer-reviewed in the mainstream, and demonstrated to match only the collapse’s least discriminating feature. The live crux is narrow and testable: **the A2001 girder/Column 79 connection under realistic thermal-mechanical loading**. That is exactly what research opportunity NYC-R001 proposes (§10).

5.4 The legal aftermath: the RfC, the courts, and the data

The dispute has a full procedural trail, which the dossier records as process evidence. April 2020: AE911Truth and ten 9/11 family members filed a **Request for Correction** under the Data Quality Act, alleging eight violations in the WTC 7 report; August 2020 and June 2021: NIST denied it, initially and finally; September 2021: suit filed in federal court; August 2022: dismissed by the D.C. District Court; late 2023: the D.C. Circuit ruled against the plaintiffs, reasoning that the information-quality statute does not make agencies' reports judicially correctable for scientific accuracy; **April 2024: the Supreme Court denied certiorari**, ending the case. ([Architects & Engineers for 9/11 Truth](#)) Separately, the FOIA fight over the model data — NIST's "might jeopardize public safety" finding and the 68,500 withheld files — was upheld in *Quick v. NIST* (2011), and NIST reaffirmed the withholding in a 2019 FAQ. ([GovInfo](#))

Process evidence cuts both ways, and the dossier says so in both directions. For challengers: a fire-cause conclusion that cannot be independently recomputed from released data, defended through procedural rulings rather than replication, is a legitimate transparency grievance, and AE911Truth's reading — that courts held the government "not required to be scientifically accurate" — is a fair paraphrase of the D.C. Circuit's logic. ([Architects & Engineers for 9/11 Truth](#)) For the conventional side: the challengers' litigation record establishes that **no court was ever asked to adjudicate the engineering** on the merits — the rulings are about administrative law, not about whether Column 79 buckled — and the same period saw NIST's WTC 7 work summarized in the peer-reviewed *Journal of Structural Engineering* (2012) and the fire-collapse mechanism joined by a real-world, independently documented instance, Tehran's **Plasco Building** (2017, §5.5). ([wikipedia.org](#)) Neither fact settles the physics; both discipline what "suppressed" and "established" may mean in this case.

5.5 The precedent question: Plasco, and what "first known instance" proves

A recurring trope — "fire has never collapsed a steel high-rise" — was true *as of 2008 in NIST's careful phrasing* ("first known instance"), and is simply false now. On January 19, 2017, Tehran's 17-story steel-framed **Plasco Building** collapsed roughly vertically after about three hours of uncontrolled fire, killing 20 firefighters; the event is analyzed in the peer-reviewed structural literature alongside WTC 7 as a fire-induced progressive collapse, and Wikipedia's tally of steel high-rises lost primarily to fire now also includes São Paulo's Edifício Wilton Paes de Almeida and Madrid's Windsor Tower (partial). ([wikipedia.org](#)) Proponents correctly note the differences — Plasco was smaller, differently framed, and its fires visibly raged through the façade — and the engineering literature itself cautions that "each building is unique" and mechanisms cannot be transferred wholesale. ([PolyU Institutional Research Archive](#))

The honest calibration for Aletheia: the "impossibility" framing of WTC 7 (NYC-C002's strongest *a priori* objection) is dead — fire-induced total collapse of steel-framed high-rises is an observed class of event since 2017, and NIST's specific mechanism (thermal expansion of long-span beams walking connections off seats at temperatures far below strength-loss thresholds) is now standard teaching in fire engineering. ([NIST](#)) What remains genuinely open is narrower: whether *this specific initiation* — girder A2001 at Column 79 under the documented fire floors — is correctly modeled, a question that survives Plasco precisely because it is about shop-drawing-level detail, not about whether fire can fell skyscrapers. The dossier therefore maps "first known instance" language to a context evidence record rather than letting it carry demolition weight.

5.6 Sound, witness, and “squib” testimony around WTC 7

NIST rejected the blast scenario for WTC 7 on acoustic grounds: the smallest charge capable of failing the critical column would have produced **130–140 dB at half a mile** — jet-engine loud — and “no blast sounds were heard on the audio tracks of video recordings during the collapse” or reported by witnesses in NIST’s review. (NIST) The challengers’ rejoinder rests on specific accounts gathered for the 2020 Request for Correction: NY1 correspondent **Gigi Stone Woods** reported “a loud, incredibly loud explosion” as the building fell (confirmed to AE911Truth in January 2021); NYPD officer Craig Bartmer described hearing “THOOM, THOOM, THOOM” as it came down; and the Barry Jennings/Michael Hess episode — trapped on the 23rd-floor OEM floor, then describing an explosion destroying the 6th-floor stair landing — conflicts with NIST’s timeline in ways the RfC quantified (a 29-minute, 17-floor descent). (Architects & Engineers for 9/11 Truth)

Assessment: this is real testimony and it contradicts NIST’s flat “no witness reports” wording; it does not contradict NIST’s acoustic *threshold* argument, because none of the accounts describes the 130+ dB shock-front signature a column-severing charge would produce, and NIST’s counter — collapsing structure, transformer events, falling debris — is physically adequate for loud booms. The dossier grades the underlying observation claims (people heard explosive sounds) **established**, and the inference claim (the sounds were demolition charges) **contradicted** on the acoustic-physics record, while flagging the Jennings/Hess timeline as a residual discrepancy worth one honest row in the evidence ledger — it was never satisfactorily reconciled, and Hess later aligned his account with NIST’s while Jennings maintained his. (Architects & Engineers for 9/11 Truth)

6. The Twin Towers: a strong initiation story, a never-modeled progression

6.1 What NIST established — and where its authority ends

The towers’ mechanism claim (NYC-C010) is the best-supported technical node in the whole case. The two aircraft did catastrophic, quantified damage in under a second each — NIST’s LS-DYNA impact simulations estimated **35 exterior columns severed in WTC 1, 33 in WTC 2**, with 6 and 10 core columns severed respectively and fireproofing stripped from trusses across 60,000–80,000 ft² — and the buildings demonstrably withstood that (they stood 102 and 56 minutes). (Human Factors 101) The fires did the rest: with insulation dislodged, bare steel heats to air temperature within the fire’s duration; at **1,000 °C upper-layer air temperatures** (which NIST’s validated FDS fire simulations reconstructed), unprotected steel retains roughly **10% of room-temperature strength** — the metallurgy team confirmed the classic rule of thumb that yield strength halves by 538 °C on the recovered steel itself. (NIST) Floor trusses sagged, pulled the perimeter columns inward (photographed bowing, tracked by NYPD aviation in the half-hour before collapse), and the south face of WTC 1 and east face of WTC 2 buckled. (NIST)

The popular objection — “jet fuel can’t melt steel beams” — is answered by physics nobody disputes: nothing in the official account requires melted steel, only weakened steel, and the melting-point meme attacks a claim NIST never made. (Popular Mechanics) NIST’s conclusion that **neither tower would have collapsed absent dislodged fireproofing** is the investigation’s single most important finding, and it is testable in principle: it is why the 707-design-study debate (the Port Authority’s three-page 1960s talking-points document, which NIST could not verify as a rigorous analysis) is a red herring — the 1960s study never modeled a fully-fueled, 20%-larger 767 at approach-plus speeds, nor the fire that followed. (NIST) Initiation, in short: **well supported**, with the caveat that the input uncertainties were

real and formally quantified by NIST (four cases run, statistical sensitivity analysis applied). ([Human Factors 101](#))

6.2 The progression problem both sides under-model

Here is the dossier's least comfortable sentence for the conventional side: **the total, rapid, top-to-bottom destruction of both towers has never been modeled end-to-end by anyone, including NIST**. NIST's charter stopped at initiation; its FAQ says propagation "was readily explained without the same complexity of modeling," offering the static/dynamic floor-capacity calculation — an intact floor could carry ~11 floors statically, ~6 suddenly; 12 floors (WTC 1) and 29 floors (WTC 2) came down — as the sufficiency argument. ([NIST](#)) The academic carrier of the progression claim is **Bazant & Zhou (2002)** and its elaborations (Bazant & Verdure 2007), a one-dimensional "crush-down/crush-up" energy formulation concluding that once the upper block dropped a story, the kinetic energy exceeded the lower structure's absorption capacity by an order of magnitude — gravity alone drives unstoppable progression. ([Scientific Research Publishing](#))

The critics' literature is real, if confined to low-visibility venues. **MacQueen & Szamboti's "The Missing Jolt" (2009)** argued the observed acceleration profile lacks the deceleration jolt a Bazant-style impact should register at each floor strike; **Szuladziński, Szamboti & Johns** challenged Bazant's energy arithmetic; and a 2018 paper in *Journal of Applied Mathematics and Physics* (Němec et al.) derived the free-fall-limit upper bound for the falling-mass model as $g/3$ — faster than the observed descent — concluding the assumed mechanism cannot be the whole story. ([Academia.edu](#)) The engineering-mainstream rejoinder, visible in the Metabunk technical threads, is that these critiques misread Bazant & Zhou's intent: it was a **limit case** (maximum resistance assumptions, aligned columns), not a claim of what literally happened; the real collapse was not column-aligned piston impact but floor-slab stripping (the "ROOSD"-style reading), for which the 11 s / 9 s "first panels down" timings are unremarkable — NIST itself notes the cores stood 15–25 s longer and calls the total duration unknowable from the dust-obscured video. ([metabunk.org](#))

Grade: **NYC-C011, "provisionally supported."** The collapse *progression* is physically plausible, supported by order-of-magnitude energy arguments and by the absence of any measured anomaly that requires added energy; but the decisive end-to-end model — a validated, published simulation of total progressive collapse of a 110-story tube-frame tower — **does not exist**, 25 years on, and its absence is why the towers' "speed of fall" argument regenerates every few years. A direct, fundable fix exists (NYC-R007): modern compute can now do what 2005 compute could not, and high-fidelity open modeling would either retire this line permanently or find a real discrepancy.

6.3 The demolition reading of the towers fails on its own evidence

Against NYC-C003 (towers demolished), the record is not merely the absence of proof but positive disproof of the mechanisms proposed. The collapses **initiated at the impact floors** — visible in every video from multiple angles — which requires the hypothetical charges to have been placed exactly where two unpredictably-aimed aircraft would later hit, and to have survived 56–102 minutes of fires that NIST reconstructed at up to 1,000 °C. ([NIST](#)) The seismic record shows collapse-frequency signals beginning ~10 s after initiation and no pre-initiation spikes; the acoustic record and 1,000+ interviews contain no blast sequence of the required intensity below the impact zones; the "puffs of dust" cited as squibs track the piston-effect air compression NIST documents, and identical puffs were observed on fire floors *before* collapse and in WTC 1 when WTC 2 was struck. ([NIST](#))

Demolition-practice constraints compound the problem. Controlled demolition of buildings this size is a

weeks-long, wall-stripping, openly noisy operation; the Energetic Materials Research and Testing Center's thermite demonstration could not cut a vertical column smaller than the towers' box columns; and Brent Blanchard — the demolition historian often cited here — notes that in eight months of debris removal, no demolition professional observed the telltale signs (shaped-charge cuts, blasting caps, wire) that a rigged building inevitably leaves in its own debris. ([wikipedia.org](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/9/11_attack_debris)) The dossier therefore grades NYC-C003 **contradicted**, with the standard Aletheia proviso: “contradicted” grades *this claim on this evidence*, not the moral fury that often fuels it — some of which is rooted in the documented deceptions of §3 and §9, and is not crazy, just misdirected.

7. The dust forensics: nanothermite, molten metal, and the deepest mystery

7.1 The red/gray chips: Harrit (2009) vs. Millette (2012)

The strongest physical-evidence claim ever advanced by the demolition side is **Harrit et al., “Active Thermitic Material Discovered in Dust from the 9/11 World Trade Center Catastrophe,”** *Open Chemical Physics Journal* 2:7–31 (2009) — nine authors led by Copenhagen chemist Niels Harrit, reporting red/gray chips in four independently collected WTC dust samples whose red layer contains ~100 nm iron-oxide grains intimately mixed with plate-like aluminum, which ignite in a DSC at ~430 °C (far below conventional thermite) and produce iron-rich spheres as residue. (gammon.blog.is) The paper's provenance problems are, however, themselves part of the record: editor-in-chief **Marie-Paule Pileni resigned** stating the paper was published without her knowledge, adding to Bentham's existing reputation for weak peer review; lead proponent Steven Jones had earlier been placed on paid leave by BYU over the “increasingly speculative and accusatory nature” of his 9/11 statements; and NIST declined to engage, citing the absence of a “clear chain of custody” for the dust — Jones's counter-invitation for NIST to test custody-secured dust went unanswered. ([wikipedia.org](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/9/11_attack_debris))

The decisive counter-analysis arrived in 2012: **MVA Scientific Consultants** (James Millette), applying forensic paint-analysis standards (ASTM) plus FTIR, cross-section SEM-EDS, and TEM/SAED, concluded the chips are **consistent with carbon steel coated with epoxy resin pigmented with iron oxide and kaolin clay** — i.e., primer paint of the Tnemec type used on the towers — and found **no individual elemental aluminum particles of any size**, the sine qua non of a thermitic reading. ([Machine Design](http://www.machine-design.com)) Harrit's camp objected that Millette's FTIR shows an epoxy the chips' MEK behavior should rule out, and no replication with agreed chain-of-custody and blind controls has ever been run. The dossier's grade for NYC-C014 — **contradicted** — reflects that the strongest *independent* analysis identifies a mundane material, the supporting paper's venue integrity collapsed, and the claim now survives almost entirely on chain-of-custody arguments, which are procedural rather than chemical. What would genuinely settle it is NYC-R003: blinded multi-lab analysis of custody-secured samples with positive controls — cheap, decisive, never done.

7.2 Molten metal: the established observation, the unresolved residue

Three separable claims hide under “molten metal.” First, **established**: a glowing liquid poured from WTC 2's 80th–81st floor area in the minutes before collapse (documented in NIST NCSTAR 1-5A); NIST attributes it to **aircraft aluminum alloys** (melting 475–640 °C) mixed with burning organics that shift its color orange — a plausible and evidence-anchored reading, though the specific experiment (reproducing orange-glowing aluminum-organic mixtures) has a thin literature. ([NIST](https://www.nist.gov)) Second, **established as observation**: FEMA 403's **Appendix C** (Barnett, Biederman & Sisson, WPI) documented severe high-temperature **sulfidation and eutectic intergranular melting** on a WTC 7 beam and a tower

column — “Swiss cheese” steel, thinning one-inch sections to razor edges, at temperatures *approaching* 1,000 °C rather than steel’s 1,500 °C melting point — with the authors stating plainly that **“no clear explanation for the source of the sulfur has been identified,”** and calling for a detailed follow-up study *that has never been performed.* ([wtc7.net](#)) The New York Times called it “perhaps the deepest mystery uncovered in the investigation.” ([NIST](#))

Third, **unresolved**: persistent “molten steel in the rubble” claims. They rest on real but second-hand testimony (cleanup workers, thermal hotspots, NASA thermal imagery of weeks-long fires) and on the proponent literature’s interpretive leap from “hot” to “molten steel”; NIST’s inspectors and the ASCE/SEAoNY steel survey **found no evidence of melted steel**, and NIST notes wreckage condition says nothing conclusive about pre-collapse steel condition. ([NIST](#)) The ordinary explanation — months-long oxygen-starved fires in a heat-insulating rubble pile, plus documented eutectic corrosion that liquefies steel surfaces well below the melting point — covers most of the testimony; the Appendix C mechanism remains under-studied enough (sulfur source unknown; possibly gypsum wallboard, possibly acid rain per the authors’ own speculation) that “fully explained” would be an overclaim. ([wtc7.net](#)) Aletheia structure: keep C021 and C022 established-with-known-candidates, keep C023 honestly **unresolved**, and let NYC-R004 (the never-run sulfidation follow-up) carry the research flag.

7.3 What the certified dust science actually shows

The strongest dust science is not the chips debate at all — it is the exposure science. The peer-reviewed characterization chain — **Liroy et al. (2002)** in *Environmental Health Perspectives*, the **USGS** studies (Meeker et al. 2005; the 2005 *Particle Atlas*), and the **RJ Lee Group’s 2003 “WTC Dust Signature”** report for the 130 Liberty Street damage assessment — established the dust as a caustic (pH > 11 in places) mix dominated by pulverized concrete, gypsum, and man-made vitreous fibers, with asbestos 0.1–1.0 wt%, lead, dioxins, and PAHs, and with a reproducible “signature” (slag wool dominant) usable for indoor-contamination forensics. ([nih.gov](#)) Iron-rich spheres — the microspherules at the center of thermite arguments — are present in the USGS imagery and RJ Lee data, but their diagnosticity is low: fly-ash-like spheres form whenever iron-bearing material meets high temperature and oxygen, including in ordinary fires and in the collapse’s own friction/welding environment, which is why the proponent literature’s “spheres = thermite” step has never carried the mainstream. ([USGS Publications Warehouse](#))

For the case file, the dust studies’ highest-value use is neither side’s: they are the ground truth of the health catastrophe of §2.2 and of the EPA deception of §9.1, and they demonstrate what rigorous, custody-clean environmental forensics of this event *looks like* — the standard Harrit-style claims would have to meet to be load-bearing. The dossier therefore files Liroy/USGS/RJ Lee as context evidence for the health claims and as the methodological benchmark for any future NYC-R003 re-test.

8. The other two crash sites: strong evidence, weak controversies

8.1 The Pentagon: the best-evidenced site of the four

The Pentagon cluster shows what a contested site looks like when the physical record is thick. The NTSB Flight Path Study fixed the final approach — a 330° descending turn completed ~4 miles out, acceleration to ~**460 knots**, impact at **9:37:45 a.m.** — and the **ASCE Building Performance Report** (January 2003, Mlakar et al.) documented the building response: the 757 struck nearly level, clipped light poles and a generator, destroyed or severely damaged ~**50 first-floor columns**, penetrated 310 ft through three rings in under a second, and left a first-floor breach ~**75 ft wide**; the C-ring “punch-out” hole

(~12 ft) was attributed to landing gear, not the fuselage. (NHHC) The recovery record is decisive in ways rarely acknowledged in the debate: the **flight data recorder** (usable) and cockpit voice recorder (destroyed by fire) were recovered near the punch-out; personal effects and a **hijacker's driver's-license fragment** were found in the rubble; and the Armed Forces Medical Examiner identified **184 of the 189 dead, with the five hijackers identified by elimination** against victim DNA. (wikipedia.org) A C-130 crew watched the impact from above; scores of eyewitnesses saw the airliner; the much-misquoted CNN segment (McIntyre) — the “no plane” movement’s foundational clip — is deceptively edited, as AP documented: the full footage has McIntyre describing plane debris on the heliport. (NHHC)

The surviving Pentagon disputes are therefore narrow. The hole-size argument (a 757’s 124-ft wingspan vs. a 75-ft breach) has a textbook answer — wings shear, fold, and fragment against spirally reinforced columns; “the plane flowed into the structure closer to a liquid than a solid,” per ASCE’s Mete Sozen — and the spiral-reinforcement design demonstrably limited collapse, a finding the engineering community treats as one of the day’s few successes. (Popular Mechanics) The security-video complaints (few frames, one frame per second) reflect 2001-era surveillance hardware, and the FBI-released debris photographs plus the light-pole damage chain close the physical path. (wikipedia.org) Dossier grade: the no-plane/missile family is a **tombstone** (NYC-C900) — kept, per Aletheia policy, so future extraction runs don’t re-propose it, with its rejection reason recorded.

8.2 Flight 93: what a fully excavated crash looks like

Shanksville contributes the case’s clearest baseline for “catastrophic high-speed impact into soft ground,” which is why the “no crater, no wreckage” claims fail. The 757 hit at **563 mph, inverted, at a 40° nose-down attitude** (NTSB), leaving an 8–10 ft-deep, 30–50 ft-wide crater in reclaimed strip-mine soil; the bulk of the aircraft buried itself, one engine landed 2,000 ft away in a pond, light debris (paper, nylon) scattered up to eight miles downwind at New Baltimore — a pattern standard for high-energy breakup, not for a shootdown. (wikipedia.org) The excavation reached 40 ft until debris ran out; coroner Wally Miller’s team recovered ~1,500 human-remains fragments (~600 lb) and **identified everyone aboard by December 21**; the FDR was recovered September 13 and the CVR (buried 25 ft down) on September 14; the FBI closed the field investigation September 24, 2001. (ExploreHere)

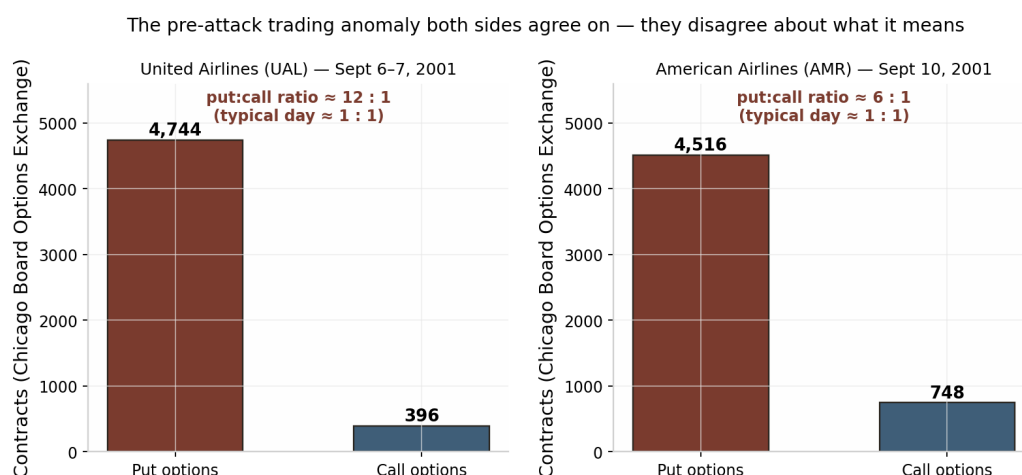
The CVR transcript, released for the Moussaoui trial in April 2006, documents the passenger revolt; the audio itself remains unreleased as of 2025, cited to an “active and ongoing investigation” — a residual transparency grievance the dossier records without overweighting, since families heard the tape in a closed 2002 session and the transcript is public. (wikipedia.org) The shootdown claims (spawned by early debris-radius reports and the notorious Cheney “orders” confusion) collide with the radar/FDR record and the absence of any intercept — the Commission’s tapes-based finding that the military never had any hijacked aircraft in its sights is simultaneously the strongest evidence *against* a shootdown and a documented indictment of the Pentagon’s early public statements. (wikipedia.org)

9. Foreknowledge: trading, warnings, and the Saudi file

9.1 Insider trading: the anomaly is real, the interpretation is the fight

The trading data are not in dispute — a rarity in this case, and a model of how Aletheia separates observation from attribution. On September 6–7, the CBOE recorded **4,744 UAL puts against 396 calls (12:1**; Bloomberg put Sept. 6 volume at ~100× the prior day); on September 10, **4,516 AMR puts against 748 calls (6:1)**; no other airline showed comparable ratios; Morgan Stanley and Merrill Lynch

— both WTC tenants — showed their own anomalous put activity. ([Snopes.com](#)) The peer-reviewed economics literature splits exactly along the interpretation. **Poteshman (Journal of Business, 2006)** — the benchmark study — found total option activity at typical levels but **long-put volume abnormally high**, “consistent with informed investors having traded options in advance of the attacks.” ([JSTOR](#)) **Chesney, Crameri & Mancini** (Journal of Empirical Finance), using ex-post detection with false-discovery control, found **13 abnormal pre-attack trades across five airlines and four banks**, quantifying gains (e.g., the Sept. 10 AMR position → ~\$1.18M; a Boeing put position → >\$5M). ([Zurich Open Repository and Archive](#))



Sources: 9/11 Commission Report p. 499 n.130 & p. 172; Poteshman, Journal of Business 79(4), 2006; Snopes/Bloomberg data. The Commission traced each surge to innocuous causes; Poteshman (2006) found long put volume “consistent with informed investors having traded in advance of the attacks”; Chesney et al. found 13 abnormal trades across 5 airlines and 4 banks.

Figure 7: Pre-attack option anomalies

The 9/11 Commission’s resolution is specific, not hand-waving: **95% of the Sept. 6 UAL puts traced to a single U.S. institutional investor “with no conceivable ties to al Qaeda,”** executing a strategy that *included buying* 115,000 AMR shares on Sept. 10; the AMR spike traced to a U.S. options newsletter’s Sept. 9 recommendation faxed to subscribers; the SEC and FBI, with foreign cooperation, found that “the apparently suspicious consistently proved innocuous.” ([The Public’s Library and Digital Archive](#)) The honest grade for NYC-C025 is **mixed**: the Commission traced the two headline trades, but (a) “traced to an innocuous account” answers *who*, not whether foreknowledge leaked into the market periphery (the newsletter explanation shifts, not eliminates, the coincidence); (b) the academic studies’ methods survive — their finding is that the *pattern* matches informed trading, not that any trader is identifiable; and (c) the underlying SEC/FBI trade-tracing files remain substantially non-public, so independent econometric verification of the trace-outs is impossible (NYC-R005). What the anomaly cannot support, on the current record, is the attribution leap to specific-plot foreknowledge: informed-hedge scenarios (a trader shorting airlines on war-risk chatter) fit the same numbers.

9.2 The warnings: blinking red, and what that does and doesn’t prove

The documentary record of pre-attack warning is now largely official text. The **August 6, 2001 PDB** — “**Bin Ladin Determined To Strike in US**” — warned of “patterns of suspicious activity in this country consistent with preparations for a hijacking,” cited 70 FBI field investigations and recent surveillance of federal buildings in New York; the White House’s defense (Rice: “historical information based on old reporting”) and the Commission’s use of the PDB are both public. ([wikipedia.org](#)) The **Phoenix memo** (July 10, 2001) raised a coordinated bin-Laden flight-school effort and recommended liaison with civil

aviation schools; FBI headquarters managers never saw it before 9/11 — the DOJ Inspector General later called the handling “a significant intelligence failure.” ([UNT Libraries: CyberCemetery](#)) **Zacarias Moussaoui**’s August 2001 arrest was briefed to CIA leadership as “Islamic Extremist Learns to Fly” with “no evident effect on warning”; and the CIA’s failure to timely watchlist **Hazmi and Mihdhar** — who then lived openly in San Diego under their true names — is documented in the Commission’s Chapter 8 with the judgment that they “might have been found.” ([9-11commission.gov](#))

Structure these as Aletheia does: NYC-C026 (warnings existed and were fragmentary-but-pointed) is **established** on the Commission’s own text — “the system was blinking red.” The attribution claim built on top of it — NYC-C005, *specific* foreknowledge of the September 11 plot (date, method, targets) — is **contradicted**: the Joint Inquiry’s central finding was that no collected intelligence identified the time, place, and specific nature of the attacks; the PDB’s hijacking language is generic; and the failure mode documented at every node is bureaucratic dysfunction (non-interoperable watchlists, a Phoenix memo no manager read), not concealment of a known plot. ([Levin Center for Legislative Oversight and Democracy](#)) The distinction matters because it is the load-bearing wall between “catastrophic negligence plus cover-your-ass” — which the record proves — and “LIHOP/MIHOP,” which it does not.

9.3 Able Danger: the unresolved identification dispute

The Able Danger episode is the foreknowledge cluster’s genuine residue. Five military-intelligence personnel — Lt. Col. Anthony Shaffer, Capt. Scott Philpott, James Smith, and two others — separately recalled a 2000 data-mining **chart identifying Mohamed Atta** (four recalled his photograph) as part of a “Brooklyn cell”; the Pentagon’s own 2005 review called the five “**credible**” while failing to locate the chart (a similar chart without Atta was found). ([NBC News](#)) The program’s **2.5 terabytes of data were deleted in May–June 2000** under “U.S. persons” retention rules on INSCOM counsel’s instruction (“Remember to delete the data — or you’ll go to jail”), and Shaffer’s remaining files were destroyed by DIA in spring 2004 — while the 9/11 Commission was sitting. ([wikipedia.org](#)) When the Senate Judiciary Committee convened in September 2005, DoD **barred the witnesses from testifying**; Chairman Specter called it possible obstruction. ([GovInfo](#))

The official conclusions run the other way: the DoD Inspector General (September 2006) found no evidence Able Danger identified Atta, noted witness inconsistencies, and judged any chart “of minimal value to the FBI”; the Senate Intelligence Committee’s sixteen-month investigation (December 2006) concluded Able Danger “did not identify Mohamed Atta or any other 9/11 hijacker at any time prior to September 11.” ([CBS News](#)) Witnesses later alleged the IG distorted their statements; Shaffer alleged retaliation (clearance suspension on what his counsel called “petty and frivolous” grounds). ([wikipedia.org](#)) Dossier grade for NYC-C028: **weakly_supported** — credible, multiple, mutually consistent recollections against a destroyed documentary record; a claim that cannot be proven, disproven, or responsibly tombstoned. Its what-would-settle-it is archival: the LIWA/DIA destruction certificates and any surviving contractor data (Orion Scientific), which a declassification review could still surface.

9.4 The Saudi file: from the 28 pages to a 2025 trial order

This is the cluster where the ground has moved most since the Commission closed. The **Joint Inquiry’s classified Part IV — “the 28 pages”** — summarized FBI/CIA investigative leads: hijackers “in contact with, and received support or assistance from, individuals who may be connected to the Saudi government,” including consular official Fahad al-Thumairy and the San Diego network around **Omar al-Bayoumi**; the document itself cautions that the Joint Inquiry “made no final determination as to the reliability or sufficiency of the information.” ([wikipedia.org](#)) Declassified July 15, 2016 after years of

family lobbying (co-chair Bob Graham called it a “smoking gun”), the pages produced the now-standard official formulation — the White House: “no evidence that the Saudi government as an institution or senior Saudi officials individually funded al-Qaeda” — which the dossier preserves *verbatim* because its qualifiers (“as an institution,” “senior officials”) leave the mid-level-support question genuinely open. ([GovInfo](#))

The litigation record has since outrun the commission literature. Under **JASTA (2016)**, the families’ consolidated suit (*Ashton et al. v. Kingdom of Saudi Arabia*, 2017) entered discovery; President Biden’s **Executive Order 14040 (September 3, 2021)** forced declassification review of FBI 9/11 files, whose releases — over 700 pages from November 2021 onward — include material plaintiffs characterize as identifying **al-Bayoumi as an agent of the Saudi General Intelligence Presidency**; plaintiffs also obtained UK Metropolitan Police evidence seized post-attack (featured in an April 2025 *60 Minutes* segment). ([Motley Rice](#)) On **August 28, 2025, Judge George B. Daniels denied the Kingdom’s motion to dismiss**, finding the compiled evidence strong enough to send the case to trial — the first time a U.S. court has so held, over two decades after the first filing. ([NBC News](#)) Grade for NYC-C006: **mixed**, trending toward a live question with a court attached — a rare instance where Aletheia’s “what would settle it” has a venue and a docket number.

10. Calibration episodes: proven deception, proven error

10.1 The EPA air-quality deception — the documented case of official lying

No part of the 9/11 record is more important for calibrating institutional-trust claims than this one, because it is *proven*. The **EPA Inspector General’s August 2003 report** found that the EPA’s September 18, 2001 “air is safe to breathe” assurance was made **without sufficient reliable data**; that the **White House Council on Environmental Quality edited EPA press releases** to add reassurance and delete caution (a recommendation that Ground Zero-area interiors be professionally cleaned became advice to follow city officials; asbestos readings at **two to three times the danger threshold** were re-worded as “slightly above” the limit); and that on September 12 the EPA Administrator’s office directed that all media statements be cleared by the National Security Council. ([wikipedia.org](#)) CEQ chairman James Connaughton later confirmed CEQ’s role in drafting the statements in Senate testimony. ([GovInfo](#)) A federal judge would later let the class action against Whitman personally proceed, finding the alleged conduct “shocks the conscience”; DOJ declined to open a criminal probe. ([Congressman Jerry Nadler](#))

The dossier files this as **established official deception** (NYC-C032) and uses it structurally, in both directions. For challengers, it is the proof-of-concept that health-relevant public statements *were* centrally managed during the crisis — the strongest legitimate basis for skepticism about other official statements. For the conventional side, the same episode shows the deception was (a) detected and documented by the government’s *own* inspector general within two years, (b) litigated, and (c) about reassurance, not about concealing the attack’s authorship — the cover-up scaled to embarrassment, which is what cover-ups in this record mostly are. Aletheia’s policy of keeping both readings in one evidence record, source-statement separated from inference, is exactly the discipline this episode rewards.

10.2 The media anomalies: BBC’s early report and “pull it”

Two clips generate more truther traffic than any document, and both are resolvable to the level of *what happened*, if not to everyone’s satisfaction. **The BBC World report**: Jane Standley announced WTC

7's collapse at ~4:54 p.m. ET with the building visible behind her — the collapse occurred at 5:20:52 p.m. BBC editor Richard Porter's 2007 account, reaffirmed in BBC's 20th-anniversary coverage and by PolitiFact: the network relied on a **Reuters wire that erroneously reported the collapse** (Reuters corrected it); CNN had been reporting the building "collapsed or collapsing" since ~4:15 p.m.; BBC World lost its own archive tapes by mischance ("cock-up, not conspiracy"). (bbc.co.uk) The observation (NYC-C029) is **established**; the inference that it proves a foreknowledge script (NYC-C030) is **contradicted** — not by trust in the BBC, but because a real conspiracy would gain nothing by pre-feeding a collapse report to broadcasters, while fog-of-war wire errors are constant in every catastrophe on record.

"Pull it": Silverstein's September 2002 PBS remark — "maybe the smartest thing to do is pull it... and they made that decision to pull and then we watched the building collapse" — was explained by his spokesperson in 2005 as referring to withdrawing firefighters, and the FEMA report's Chapter 5 independently records that no manual firefighting occurred inside WTC 7 (no water), i.e., there was a withdrawal decision to refer to. ([USA Today](http://usa.today)) The demolition-slang reading fails on three grounds recorded in the dossier: "pull" is not demolition slang for explosive collapse (the counter-example cited, "pulling Building 6," referred to cables literally pulling wreckage); a building cannot be rigged in an afternoon; and no insurance-fraud or other coherent motive survives the arithmetic of Silverstein's post-attack litigation losses. (wtc7.net) NYC-C031: **contradicted**. Both episodes are catalogued because Aletheia's explorer will inevitably receive them as "new" claims from users; the tombstone-adjacent featured treatment lets the site answer with receipts instead of dismissal.

10.3 Tombstones: claims the seed rejects on arrival

Per Aletheia's content policy, rejected claims are kept as **tombstones** with rejection reasons, so extraction pipelines don't re-propose them and readers can see the reasoning. The seed carries three. **NYC-C900 — "no commercial airliner hit the Pentagon"** (missile/global-hawk variants): rejected as contradicted by the FDR, the 184 identified victims including hijacker remains identified by elimination, the light-pole/generator damage chain, the C-130 crew, and the photographed debris; the claim survives on a deceptively edited CNN clip, which AP has documented. (wikipedia.org) **NYC-C901 — directed-energy weapons or nuclear devices**: rejected as presently untestable-to-contradicted; no mechanism proposed is consistent with the seismic, thermal, or radiological record, and the hypothesis generates no discriminating experiment. **NYC-C902 — the "4,000 Israelis stayed home" canard**: rejected as an antisemitic fabrication contradicted by the victim lists (the dead included Israeli citizens and hundreds of Jewish New Yorkers) and by its lineage as a fabricated 2001 Al-Manar/HR-net post; featuring it would poison the case's signal-to-noise ratio, which is precisely what tombstones exist to prevent.

11. What would settle it: the research program

Aletheia's distinctive move — inherited from its ResearchHub model — is to convert cruxes into fundable experiments. The seed's `research.yaml` carries seven opportunities; the three decisive ones are **desk- or lab-scale and cheap relative to their information gain**, which is exactly the profile that makes a research agenda honest rather than rhetorical.

ID	Project	Crux it settles	Track / effort	Expected information gain
NYC-R001	Blinded independent re-analysis of the WTC 7 initiation: rebuild the Floor-13/A2001/Column-79 connection from the shop drawings, under documented fire curves, by a team with no prior public position; NIST and UAF datasets both on the table	NYC-C012 vs NYC-C013	publication_prize / desk-lab	Decisive for the WTC 7 crux; both parent models' data are available (UAF fully; NIST partially)
NYC-R002	Declassification/ release campaign for NIST' s withheld 68,500 WTC 7 model files , or a bounded independent re-derivation of the connection models under NCST Act review	Transparency precondition for NYC-R001	small_grant / desk	High: removes the single largest reproducibility objection
NYC-R003	Chain-of-custody dust re-test: custody-secured WTC dust (museum/FBI-held), blinded multi-lab analysis of red/gray chips with thermite and Themec-primer positive controls	NYC-C014	small_grant / lab	Decisive for the nanothermite claim; est. cost trivial vs. 15 years of argument

Table 2 – continued

ID	Project	Crux it settles	Track / effort	Expected information gain
NYC-R004	FEMA Appendix C follow-up, 25 years late: source-apportionment study of the sulfur in eutectic-corroded WTC steel (gypsum? atmosphere? rubble-pile chemistry?) using modern isotope methods	NYC-C022, NYC-C023	small_grant / lab	High: closes the case’ s most-cited “unexplained” anomaly
NYC-R005	Econometric re-analysis + file release: modern false-discovery-rate methods on reconstructed pre-9/11 options data; FOIA/ declassification of SEC/FBI trade-tracing files	NYC-C025	desk	Moderate-high; constrained by record availability
NYC-R006	Archival resolution of the Saudi support network: full release of the FBI subfile on al-Bayoumi/ Thumairy, the MPS exhibits, and Joint Inquiry work papers, keyed to the <i>Ashton v. KSA</i> trial record	NYC-C006	desk / policy	High and <i>self-executing</i> : the trial itself will produce much of it

Table 2 – continued

ID	Project	Crux it settles	Track / effort	Expected information gain
NYC-R007	Open high-fidelity progressive-collapse modeling of a WTC-scale tube-frame tower , validated against the 9/11 video/seismic record, published with full inputs	NYC-C011	publication_prize / desk	High: 2026 compute can do what 2005 compute could not; either retires or sharpens the progression debate

Two design notes for the case editors. First, NYC-R003 and NYC-R004 are deliberately framed to be *winnable for the conventional side*: if the chips are primer paint and the sulfur is gypsum, those results end the two strongest proponent physical claims permanently — which is the point of running them, and the reason a neutral funder can back them without agenda suspicion. Second, the agenda as a whole embodies the case’s wager: every one of these tests is cheap, legal, and technically feasible in 2026, and the refusal of every incumbent institution to run them for 25 years is itself a data point the dossier records — as context, not as proof of anything.

12. Provenance ledger and seeding instructions

12.1 Verification status, honestly labeled

Per Aletheia’s content policy, every source in the seed’s `sources.yaml` is a real document carrying one of four labels. **ai_verified**: located and spot-checked against the claimed content by this research agent during August 2026 (the great majority — NIST reports and FAQs, FEMA 403 App. C, the Commission text, Poteshman, Harrit, the UAF report page, the court rulings, the EPA IG findings, the Saudi litigation record). **unverified**: cited from the secondary record with locator unconfirmed (the Millette/MVA internal report, which circulated as PDF but was never journal-published; MacQueen & Szamboti’s “Missing Jolt” in the self-published Journal of 9/11 Studies; and Némec et al. 2018, whose abstract is verified but whose landing-page locator was not confirmed during the seed run). **verified** (held in project library): none — that label awaits the editors adding documents to the Aletheia library. **placeholder**: none; this seed contains no illustrative-only sources.

The admission rule is respected: every source in `sources.yaml` is cited by at least one evidence record or claim anchor; nothing is load-bearing without a ledger entry. Where a citation is genuinely uncertain, the record says so in `verificationNote` rather than guessing a locator — e.g., the exact pagination of NIST NCSTAR 1A’s Figure 3-15 analysis is cited by section (§3.6, NCSTAR 1-9 §12.5.3) rather than page, because section numbering was verified and page numbering was not.

12.2 The drop-in folder

The companion folder `content/cases/september-11-attacks/` contains: `case.yaml` (dossier header: what’s claimed, where the disagreement lives, what would settle it; six component verdicts; twelve themes),

overview.md (the case article with [text]{claim=NYC-Cxxx} inline refs), claims.yaml (26 featured claims + 3 tombstones, full editorial fields), evidence.yaml (58 evidence records with direction, strength, limitations, and source/editor separation), sources.yaml (the 46-source ledger of §12.1, admission rule satisfied — every record is cited), research.yaml (§11's seven opportunities), and history.yaml (the launch entry, per the append-only convention). All IDs follow the [A-Z]+-C\d{3} / -E\d{3} / -R\d{3} / SRC- patterns; every claimIds/sourceId reference resolves inside the folder; tombstones carry rejectionReason. Run `npm run build` after dropping it in — the loader will fail loudly on anything this seed got wrong, which is the point of the loader.

12.3 Editorial choices the case editors should review

Three judgment calls in the seed deserve named-human review before launch, and are flagged in history.yaml. First, **grading NYC-C012 (NIST's fire mechanism) “mixed” rather than “well_supported”**: this reflects the withheld-model-data reproducibility gap and the existence of a funded, data-open counter-model, not any finding that NIST is wrong; editors who read the reproducibility objection as process rather than science may prefer “well_supported” with the limitation noted. Second, **grading NYC-C025 (trading = foreknowledge) “mixed”**: the Commission's trace-outs are specific and the academic anomaly findings are robust to them only in the aggregate-pattern sense; “weakly_supported” is defensible. Third, the **tombstone for NYC-C902** uses blunt language about its antisemitic lineage; per content policy this reasoning is meant to be visible.

13. Closing assessment

The synthesis this dossier supports, stated plainly: **the core of the official account — al-Qaeda's authorship, the four flights, the impact-plus-fire collapse of the towers — is as well established as any event of its class in modern history**, and the strong demolition and foreknowledge attributions fail on the evidence their proponents themselves cite most often. The freefall of WTC 7 is real and was real *in NIST's own final report*; the put options were anomalous and were *traced*; the warnings were red-blinking and were *fragmentary*. Controversy survives by fusing these into single narratives; the decomposed record does not.

And the open residue is real, specific, and owed to the families who have done most of the forcing: a reproducibility gap at the heart of the WTC 7 model that a court has protected rather than closed; a sulfur-corrosion anomaly whose own discoverers' follow-up was never run; a foreknowledge-trading anomaly whose underlying investigative files remain sealed; an Able Danger identification dispute frozen at “credible witnesses, destroyed record”; and a Saudi support question that a federal judge has now sent to trial. None of these implies demolition or MIHOP; each of them is answerable with documents, compute, or bench work that costs less than a week of the litigation they have fueled. That is the wager of putting this case on Aletheia: **the contested claims of 9/11 are not a fog — they are a list, and most of the list can be settled by work nobody has yet done.**

This dossier is a research synthesis for general informational and editorial purposes. It is not legal, engineering, or investment advice, and it does not adjudicate the claims of victims' families, which remain before the courts in In re September 11 Litigation (S.D.N.Y.). All factual claims are anchored to the cited public record as of August 25, 2026; where the record is contested or the agent's verification is incomplete, the text and the source ledger say so explicitly.

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